# Making Your PACE Plan

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# WELCOME & INTRODUCTIONS

- No need for any radio experience
- No need to take notes – our handout has all this info in it!
- Trainer intro
- Please introduce yourself to someone you don’t know
  - Name, pronouns, and one reason you came tonight

# What is PACE?

PACE is a framework for planning redundant communications for your community.

Primary: Your main, go-to communication method. The one you use every day.

Alternate: A backup that's nearly as capable, but on different infrastructure.

Contingency: A more limited option for when both primary and alternate fail.

Emergency: The last resort. It works when nothing else does.

# Tips for Building Your PACE Plan

Know your threat model: What are you planning for?

Ensure true independence: Each tier should rely on different infrastructure.

- If your primary and alternate both need cell towers...
- Cell-based → Radio-based → Mesh/Satellite → Physical/Human

Keep it simple: The best plan is one people will actually follow.

- If your contingency method is 20 steps long, it will fail under stress.
- Choose methods your group can realistically learn and execute.

# Real-World PACE Example 1

Wilderness Search and Rescue Teams

**P**: UHF/VHF radios on team frequency

**A**: Cell phone (when in coverage areas)

**C**: Satellite messenger, e.g. Garmin inReach

**E**: Whistle signals / return to base camp

# Real-World PACE Example 2

Family of Preppers

**P**: Phone or Signal group

**A**: GMRS or Ham radios with pre-programmed channels

**C**: Meshtastic devices

**E**: Pre-determined meeting place

# Drafting Your PACE Plan

Get into two groups and briefly discuss your individual emergency communication needs.

- Discuss your own 4 W's:
  - *Who* all you need to talk to, *when*, *where*, and *why*.
  - These answers will all inform your *how*.
- Now choose the person with the most challenging needs and together draft a PACE plan for them.
- Now let's go over the two plans together!

# Drafting Your Neighborhood PACE Plan

Now get into one big group and draft a PACE plan for your neighborhood.

# Triggers to Shift Methods

Define clear triggers so everyone in your group knows when to switch methods. Examples:

- **P** → **A**: No response on text message after 15 minutes during an active event; cell service is degraded or absent.
- **A** → **C**: GMRS is jammed up with too many other users.
- **C** → **E**: Prolonged power outage; devices lost or inaccessible.

Now add clear triggers to your neighborhood PACE plan.

# Document, Distribute & Practice

Write your PACE plan down, e.g. print it on a laminated card. Make sure everyone has a copy.

- Schedule regular drills where you practice using your backup methods:
- "No-cell Sunday": Coordinate your group using only GMRS radios for a day.
- Comms blackout drill: Simulate the internet going down; switch to your alternate/contingency and time how long it takes to reach everyone.
- Equipment check: Verify batteries are charged, frequencies are correct, and everyone remembers how to use each device.

# Conclusion

1. PACE plans ensure you can communicate with your people in a disaster.
2. It stands for Primary, Alternate, Contingent and Emergency.
3. Each tier must be on different infra than the rest.
4. You must have clear triggers to escalate tiers.
5. Your PACE plan is only as good as people's knowledge of it and experience and practice using it!

# FEEDBACK ;)




This is the most important part for us!

- The more candid you are, the more we can improve.
- Thank you for participating and we will stay to answer any further questions you may have!